

Midnight Rambler

STOMPBOX SERIES #01 • USER MANUAL (V1.0.0)

Main St Audio Labs • <https://mainstaudiolabs.github.io>



1. The Tweed 5E3 Soul: A Studio Legend

The **Fender Tweed Deluxe 5E3** (1950s) is widely regarded by producers and guitarists as the ultimate studio recording amplifier in rock history. Its simple 6V6 tube circuit delivers an unmistakable organic compression, warm harmonics, and touch-sensitive response that larger stadium amps cannot replicate.

From Keith Richards' classic Rolling Stones rhythm crunch (*Sticky Fingers*, *Exile on Main St.*) and Neil Young's roaring grit to Billy Gibbons' Texas blues bite and the legendary guitar tracks on *Hotel California*, the Tweed 5E3 shaped generations of iconic records.

Why Midnight Rambler Sets a New Standard

Unlike static impulse responses or generic digital modeling plugins that feel stiff and sterile, **Midnight Rambler** captures the living, breathing acoustic soul of a boutique-calibrated Tweed 5E3:

- **True Neural Dynamics:** Powered by cutting-edge Neural Amp Modeler (NAM) deep neural networks, responding seamlessly to your guitar's volume knob and picking dynamics.
- **Intelligent Input Protection & Noise Suppression:** Built-in adaptive Noise Gate (-58 dBFS) and pre-NAM -0.1 dBFS analog waveshaper limiter ensure pristine signal integrity with zero background hiss.
- **Mix-Ready Studio Suite:** Independent post-amp State-Variable TPT filters (Bass HP & Tone LP) combined with zero-latency 1971 Oxford 12" studio cabinet convolution (Royer R121 ribbon and Shure SM57).
- **Zero Latency & 100% Free:** No accounts, no dongles, ultra-low CPU consumption. Plug in, turn up, and sound like a classic record immediately.

2. Quick Control Guide

The pedal features 4 intuitive main knobs and 3 rotary switches:

Main Knobs

- **VOLUME / GAIN** (`1.0` to `10.0`): Controls input drive feeding the tube engine. Lower settings provide sparkling clean headroom; higher settings deliver thick vintage saturation and singing sustain.
- **BASS** (HP Filter · `20 Hz` to `300 Hz`): Tightens the low-end and eliminates unwanted sub-bass rumble, keeping rhythm tracks punchy.
- **TONE** (LP Filter · `1.0 kHz` to `20.0 kHz`): Controls top-end presence and smooths out harsh frequencies for a warm, woody character.
- **MASTER** (`1.0` to `10.0`): Clean linear output level with up to `+18 dB` of clean boost headroom.

Selectors & Switches

- **CHANNEL** (Edge / Cranked):
 - **EDGE**: Dynamic edge-of-breakup tone with ultra-sensitive pick response.
 - **CRANKED**: Rich, saturated vintage overdrive with thick power-tube compression.
- **MIC / CAB** (Speaker Cabinet IR):
 - **WARM**: Royer R121 ribbon microphone for a smooth, body-rich vintage response.
 - **SHARP**: Shure SM57 dynamic microphone with bite and focused upper-mid punch.
 - **BLEND**: Curated 60/40 studio combination (SM57 + R121) for balanced depth and realism.
- **STANDBY** (Play / Mute): Instantly mutes audio output and drops CPU usage to `0%`.
- **Dynamic Background**: Drag and drop any image file (`.jpg` or `.png`) directly onto the plugin window to change its skin on the fly.

3. Audio Configuration (Standalone)

When running the pedal as a standalone application, configure your audio settings as follows for optimal performance:

1. **Audio Device Type**: Always select **ASIO** on Windows to avoid latency and digital distortion.
2. **Device**: Select the native ASIO driver of your audio interface (e.g. Focusrite USB ASIO).
3. **Sample Rate**: Set to **48000 Hz** (48 kHz).
4. **Buffer Size**: Set buffer size to **128 samples** (2.3 ms) or **256 samples** (5.3 ms).

4. System Requirements & Distribution

- **Operating Systems:** Windows 10/11 (64-bit), macOS 10.13+ (Intel & Apple Silicon), Linux (64-bit).
- **Processor (CPU):** AVX2 instruction support required on Windows/Linux (Intel Core 4th Gen / AMD Ryzen+). Apple Silicon natively supported.
- **Formats:** VST3, Audio Unit (macOS), Standalone App.
- **Distribution:** 100% self-contained. All neural models and cabinet IRs are embedded internally inside the binary file.

5. License & Terms of Use

Main St Audio Labs - Freeware EULA

Midnight Rambler is distributed as **Freeware (Closed-Source)**. You are 100% free to use this plugin in any personal, educational, or commercial music production, mix, score, or live performance without paying any royalties or fees. Reverse engineering, decompiling, reselling, or charging for binary downloads is strictly prohibited. All rights belong exclusively to Main St Audio Labs. Third-party brand names (Fender, Tweed Deluxe, 5E3) are used solely for descriptive identification of tone.

Main St Audio Labs · Contact: mainstaudiolabs@gmail.com · Web: <https://mainstaudiolabs.github.io>